

Jabra Elite 5

Solid daily drivers

When the Jabra Elite 5 showed up at the Digit Test Centre, there was an air of excitement around these TWS earbuds. However, before anyone could get their hands on the earbuds, the reviewer took them for a spin. And the testing results were interesting. Here's what we found out when we tested the Jabra Elite 5 TWS earbuds.

BUILD AND DESIGN

With the Jabra Elite 5, the company has been consistent with its case quality and design, including the material and the overall feel of the earbuds. The front of the case has a subtle Jabra branding, below which is the charging indicator LED. When you flip the case around, you see the USB-C type charging port. The rest of the case is plain and classy, with just a small embossed bit of branding present at the bottom. Upon opening the top lid of the case, you are welcomed by the glittery button covers of the earbuds, with the branding making a subtle reappearance again. While the magnets holding the top lid in place are strong, we would have loved it if there was a metallic hinge on the case. As for the buds themselves, they are lightweight, and thanks to the three pairs of EarGels that Jabra has included, the fit is great. The lobes fit snugly in the ears of most people at the Digit Test Centre.

FEATURES

Instead of beating around the bush and including gimmicky features, Jabra has gone for the quality-over-quantity approach. Starting off with voice assistant compatibility. The pickup of the voice command was almost instant and seamless, with the lag between the command being said and the action being triggered being minimal. Next comes the Hybrid ANC that has been advertised by Jabra. As per the description given by Jabra, the earphones equipped with Hybrid ANC take the reading of noise levels not only



outside your ears but also in your ear canal. Depending on the levels, both inside and outside, your ANC levels and intensity would be determined. Spoiler alert: It worked well. Additionally, the case has wireless charging capabilities, with the Qi-certified wireless charging.

As for the app, we were presented with the Jabra Sound+ app, which gives us a lot of customisation options. It has a five-band equaliser, which makes sure that you can tune the sound to your liking. The purists at Digit Test Centre are always looking for an EQ with as many bands as possible, but something is better than nothing. And not to forget, these earbuds are rated IP55.

PERFORMANCE

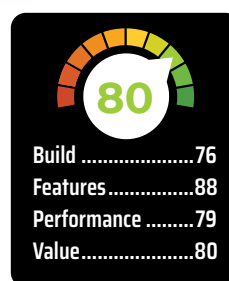
With Jabra products, we generally expect a decent-sounding pair of earbuds. The bass frequencies had a subtle boost, while the mids came pretty close to our baseline reading of the pink noise. In the higher frequencies, we did see a spike in the 2000-4000kHz frequency range. But, when all of this is put together, you get a sound signature that is well-rounded. We found it to be great for regular content consumption and music listening needs. Be it regular OTT content or heavy metal songs, you will never be left wondering where were the sounds that you were expecting from these earbuds. Again, the purists at the Test Centre were left looking for something

more that we are sure Jabra is capable of pulling off. However, that is us. In your use, for the most part, you will find these to be perfect. In terms of the microphone performance, and ANC performance, these TWS earbuds held their own both in relatively quiet office environments as well as noisy outdoor environments.

BATTERY

Jabra claims that these earbuds come with 7 hours of battery life in the earbuds. With four more additional rounds of charging from the case, the total battery life comes to about 28 hours. In our tests, we found that the earbuds lasted for six and a

half hours, with the case providing four more charges, bringing the total battery life up to 26 hours. This, complemented by the fast charging capability of these earbuds over USB-C, makes these earbuds a pair that will get you through a day of work without much hassle.



VERDICT

With the Jabra Elite 5, Jabra has reaffirmed its position in the TWS earbuds market. The biggest competitors in this space right now are the Samsung Galaxy Buds 2 Pro, the LG Tone Free FP9, along with the Sony WF-LS900N. While the offering from Samsung is a solid deal, the cost bump might be a deal breaker for you. This leaves the Sonys, and the LG earbuds, which we'd say are catered towards a specific audience. The bottom line with the Jabra Elite 5, is that it is a solid offering by Jabra. So, if you are looking to take the plunge right away, go ahead.

—Satvik Pandey

SPECIFICATIONS

Dimensions (WxHxD): 20mm x 20.54mm x 27mm | IP rating: IP55 | Bluetooth version: 5.2 | Active Noise-Cancellation (ANC): Hybrid ANC | Speaker bandwidth (music mode): 20Hz - 20000Hz | Speaker bandwidth (speak mode): 100Hz - 8000Hz | Audio codecs supported: AAC, Qualcomm aptX™, SBC

CONTACT

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